

ZARA SALES ANALYSIS

Zara, one of the world's leading fast-fashion retailers, generates sales performance data across a wide range of products, materials, seasons, and store display formats. This analysis draws on a 20,250-product dataset combining Product ID, Position, Promotion status, Category, Seasonal flag, Sales Volume, Price, Material, Origin, Gender segment, and Season to uncover what drives sales performance across Zara's catalog.

Business Problem

Zara needs to understand the key drivers of sales volume across product categories including material, display position, promotions, seasonal trends, and gender preference to optimize product placement, marketing strategy, and inventory management to drive profitability and customer satisfaction.

Objectives

- Determine which product sub-category generates the highest sales volume.
- Evaluate the influence of product display position on sales volume.
- Analyze the effect of promotions and discounts on product sales.
- Identify gender-based preferences across product sub-categories.
- Explore preferred materials by sub-category and by season.
- Uncover top-performing products for restocking guidance.

Key Insights

- Jackets lead every category generating \$487.02M in revenue and 12.3M units sold, more than double the next closest sub-category (sweaters).
- Aisle placement outperforms other positions indicating that products displayed in the aisle recorded the highest sales volume (38.32%), ahead of endcap (33.62%) and front-of-store (28.06%) placements.
- Promotions show a limited, category-dependent effect which means that discounted products did not consistently outsell non-discounted ones, suggesting some customers associate heavy discounting with lower perceived quality.
- Autumn is the strongest season as sales volume peaks in autumn (8.0M) after dropping to its lowest point in summer (3.4M), with wool and wool-blend materials driving the autumn spike.
- Women drive most sales as they account for the larger share of purchases across every sub-category, led by jackets, sweaters, and t-shirts.

- Material preference shifts by season as wool dominates autumn/winter, cotton and linen dominate spring/summer, giving clear direction for seasonal sourcing.
- A small set of “hero” products (led by the Plaid Overshirt at 9.1K units) sell significantly above the company average of 1,097 units, and account for a disproportionate share of revenue.

Recommendations

- Restock top-performing products and replicate their styling and materials in upcoming collections to sustain revenue from proven “hero” items.
- Optimize product placement by prioritizing aisle positioning for best-sellers, and rotating underperforming products into aisle space to evaluate uplift.
- Refine promotional strategy and concentrate discounts on low-performing and seasonal stock, and limit promotions on top-performing products to protect margins.
- Align seasonal inventory with material trends: Increase wool and wool-blend production ahead of autumn/winter, and cotton/linen ahead of spring/summer.
- Launch gender-targeted campaigns that pair preferred sub-categories and materials with the right season, rather than running one-size-fits-all marketing.
- Strengthen material procurement by negotiating better terms for high-volume materials (cotton, wool) and reducing exposure to consistently low-performing materials.
- Extend the analysis with customer-level RFM (Recency, Frequency, Monetary) segmentation to sharpen retention and personalization strategy.

Conclusion

This analysis shows that product visibility, promotional strategy, seasonal timing, and material choice all shape Zara's sales performance. Applying these insights from aisle-first placement to season-aligned sourcing gives Zara a clear, data-backed path to improve marketing efficiency, reduce overstocking, and sustain profitability in a highly competitive fashion market.